Tim Everard

Operations Leader, Rostering, Resourcing and Budgets

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PROFILE

Operations leader with 15 years' experience in resource planning and rostering for live events and broadcast, most recently as Head of Esports Operations at BLAST. Led a six-person department and, across six years, planned, booked, contracted and scheduled 2,000+ freelancers across 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries, working to €12m+ in budgets. Managed freelancers, vendors and suppliers, tracked event budgets and deadlines in planning tools built for the department, met finance fortnightly to align on budgets, and rebuilt how the team works with clear ownership and documentation. Used to stakeholder management with commercial and production teams, and to continuous improvement, turning a plan into a delivered, well-staffed operation.

2,000+	€12m+	60+	300+	13
freelancers	in budgets	flagship events	qualifiers	countries

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
BLAST

- Designed and built the department's own planning tools for event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Met the finance team fortnightly to align on budgets
- Resourced the department's events through freelancer booking, contracting and scheduling, working with vendors and suppliers
- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Rebuilt how the department works, as continuous improvement, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams, as a stakeholder across the business
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs

KEY SKILLS

Rosters and resource planning
Staff rosters, freelancer calendars, holiday cover, emergency call-outs

Resourcing and workforce planning
Freelancer booking, contracting and payments across the event calendar, hire-or-buy decisions

Budgets and finance
Tracking budgets, fortnightly budget alignment with finance, invoice approval, business cases, pitch costings

Team leadership
Team leadership, people management, restructuring, training

Vendors and stakeholders
Vendor and supplier management, stakeholder management with product, commercial and finance teams

Continuous improvement and planning tools
Process improvement, planning tools built in Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

Safeguarding and safety
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Booked, contracted and scheduled tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six, tracking spend as the events ran
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Hired freelancers and ran staff rosters to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Managed suppliers and vendors, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Hired freelance crew, managed rosters and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance
- Managed production for both studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Carried out PAT testing on the venue's electrical equipment